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By JOHN J. McGRAW (Manager, New York Giants.)
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McGraw Is Still on Trail Of a Jewish Ball Player

Signing of Hebrew Star Would Be Shrewd Business Move, Giant Manager Declares. Cubs' Pitching Praised.

By JOHN J. McGRAW
(Manager, New York Giants.)

NEW YORK, July 16.—A Pittsburgh fan, having learned that young Sidney Cohen is with the Giants for a try-out, wants to know if I am still determined in my quest for a good Jewish ball player. He is also kind enough to add that my past efforts in that direction would indicate that I am a better sport than was Henry Ford before he discovered his mistake and made his now famous apology.

Yes, I am still in search of a Jewish ball player and I am almost convinced that I will have one wearing the New York uniform before the end of another season. Reports would indicate that Andy Cohen, Sidney's older brother, is developing rapidly in the minor league where I sent him, and I will recall him just as soon as he seems to be ready.

My efforts are not particularly to show that I am a good sport. I think it would be good baseball business in many ways. A good ball player is an asset no matter what his creed or religion.

On top of that the Jewish fans are one of the biggest supporting elements in our game and it is but natural that for years they should long to see a star Jewish ball player on the field. I am more than anxious to encourage them. We haven't had a really great one since Johnny Kling.

There is no prejudice against Jewish players in the major leagues and I feel sure that the big majority of Jewish fans are convinced of that.

As a matter of fact the Jews are the ones who have shown themselves good sports in baseball and I have had an excellent proof of it ever since I announced my intention of securing a good player from among them if I had to scour the country.

I have tried out several Jewish players and the good sportsmanship of their followers is shown in the fact that not once have I been criticized for letting them go. The Jewish fans have recognized the failure of these men to make good and have not complained. They did not think they were good ball players simply because they were Jews. The fact is the Jewish fans don't want a Jewish player unless he is exceptionally good.

Now there is racial pride for you: It is also a high form of sportsmanship. I have never heard one of them complain of favoritism. I can't imagine anything more nonsensical than favoritism on a ball club. The main idea is to win a pennant and no sensible manager would allow favoritism to interfere with that ambition.

I have a lot of fun with the Jewish fans over my efforts to get a Jewish ball player, t' ·ugh.

While watching Sidney Cohen the other day, I jokingly remarked to Louie Mann that if I developed a star in New York, I would insist on going fifty-fifty with him in the clothing business next fall.

"You might," laughed Louie, "if I didn't beat you to it."

This boy Sidney, by the way, has some earmarks of being a real ball player. He certainly can field beautifully. As to his hitting, of course, I do not know. Sidney is not signed with the Giants. He is with us simply for a tryout and is doing it at his own expense.

In the meantime, we are beginning to get results from our pitching staff and before this Western invasion is over, I have hopes of seeing the Giants in a contending position and fighting hard for the lead.

The good sign came last week when we had two pitchers—Fitzsimmons and Barnes score shut-outs in succession. Now, if you will look over the scores of the past month you will notice that the teams have climbed in exact proportion to the steadiness of their pitchers.

The Chicago Cubs, for example, have played several games in which their pitchers allowed less than six hits. The club, even without as strong a punch as some others, has kept right along with the pitchers.

The Cardinals have not suffered so much from bad pitching as from injuries that have kept their star regulars out of the game. If you will scan the dope a little closer you will also notice that with very few exceptions the teams have slipped in proportion to the number of regulars out of the game. It is impossible almost to make a machine work effectively with any one of the cogs missing. Our club has wobbled about from that cause much of the season. We have kept our punch, but that advantage has been offset by the unsteadiness of the pitching. From now on I look to see things work more smoothly.

A club that makes an average of six runs a game, if blessed with anything like steady pitching, ought to keep well out in front. Often I have heard Matty say: "Just give me one run, fellows. That'll be enough."

All season we have been giving the pitchers an average of six runs, and still could not win consistently. Whenever you see those scores of 10 to 8 or 11 to 10—very frequent this season—you may know that the pitching on both sides has been unreliable.

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